

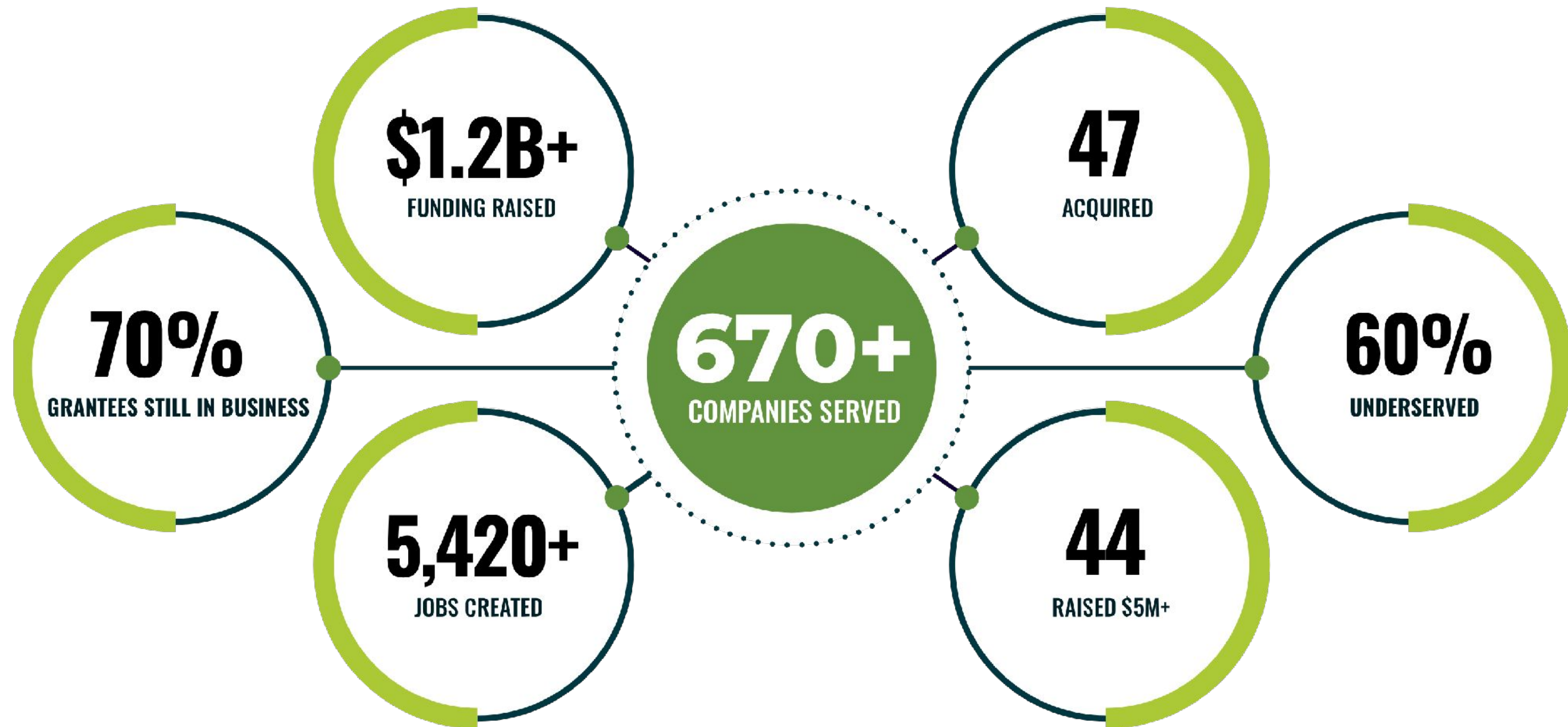


FOUNDATION(S)

Pittsboro

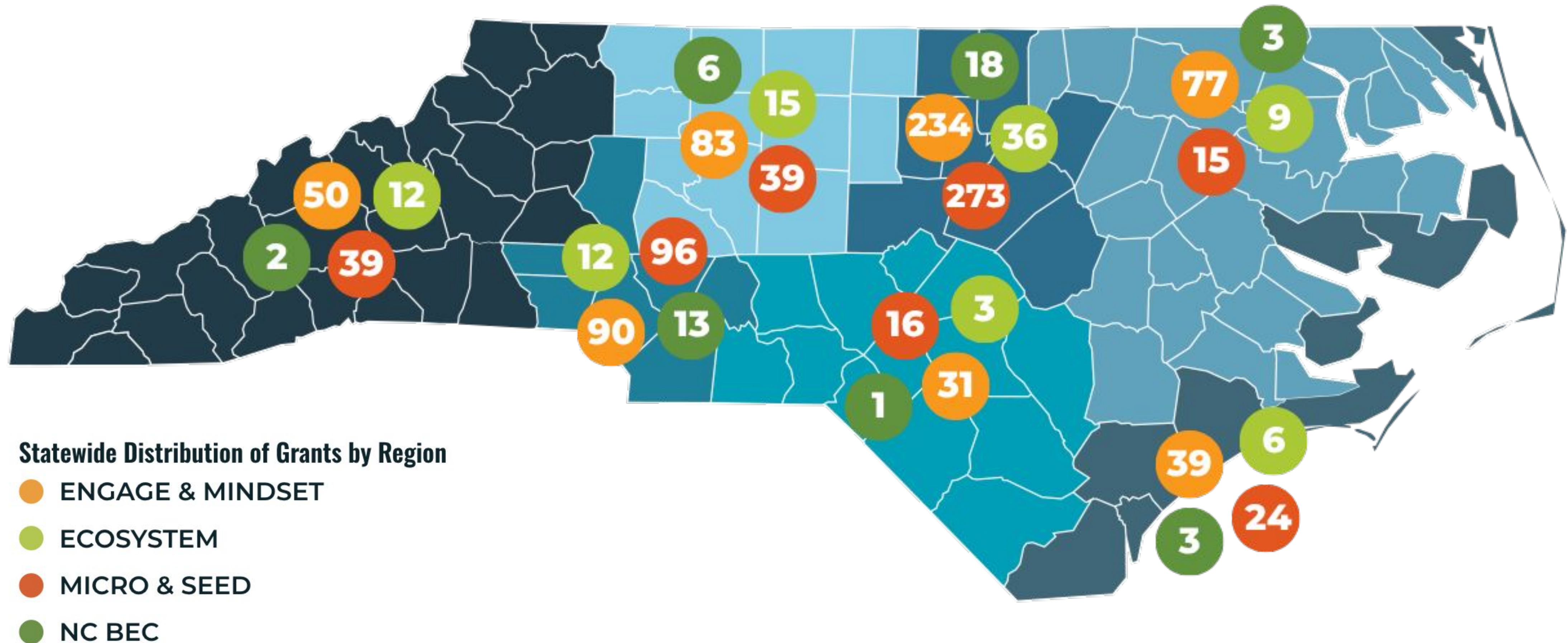
Fall 2026

Our Impact



Our Footprint

1,245+ GRANTS = \$27.7M+



• 11 Rural Impact Grants (awarded to rural companies) are calculated in the MICRO & SEED figures
• 7 GROWTH Grants (awarded to Black-led companies) are calculated in the NC BEC figures

Program Portfolio

FOUNDATION(S)

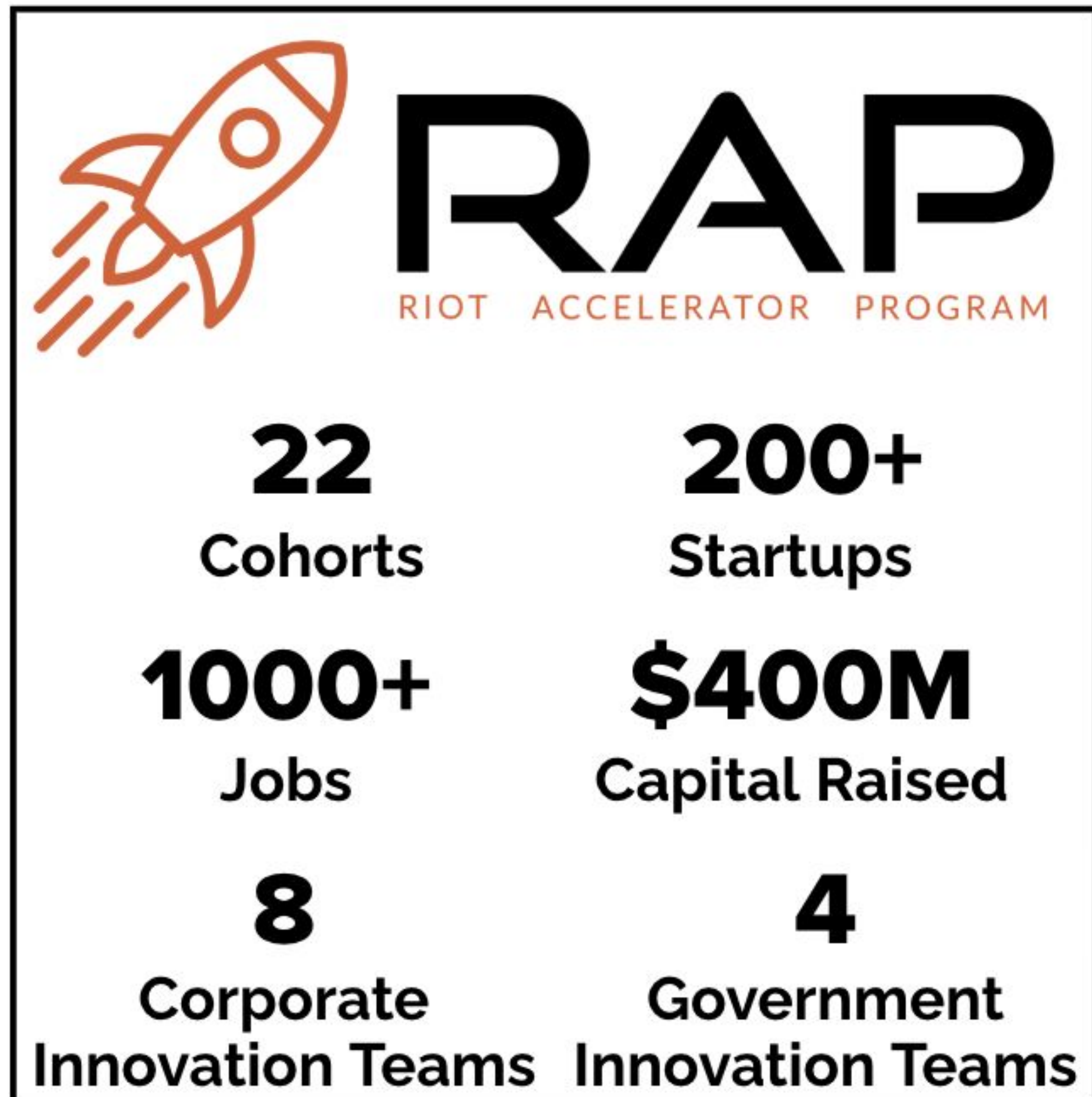
*8-week Idea Stage
Market Validation*

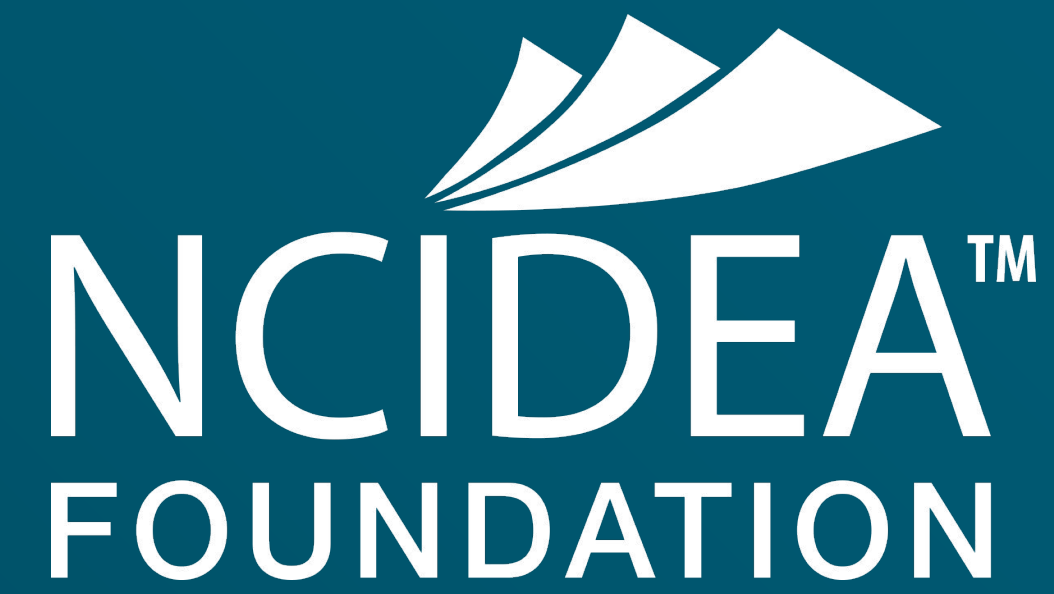
RIoT Accelerator Program

*12-week
Pilot & Growth Stage
Scaling Sales*

Founders' Roundtable

*Monthly Support Meeting
CEO Peer Network*





Why Are We Here?

NC IDEA Programs Team



Carlo Diy
Program Manager



Alexis Gant
Program Operations Coordinator



Rachael Newberry
Sr. Director, Programs

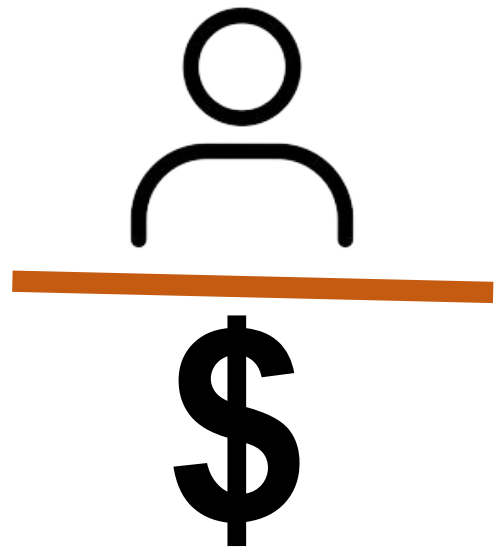


Tom Snyder
VP, Programs



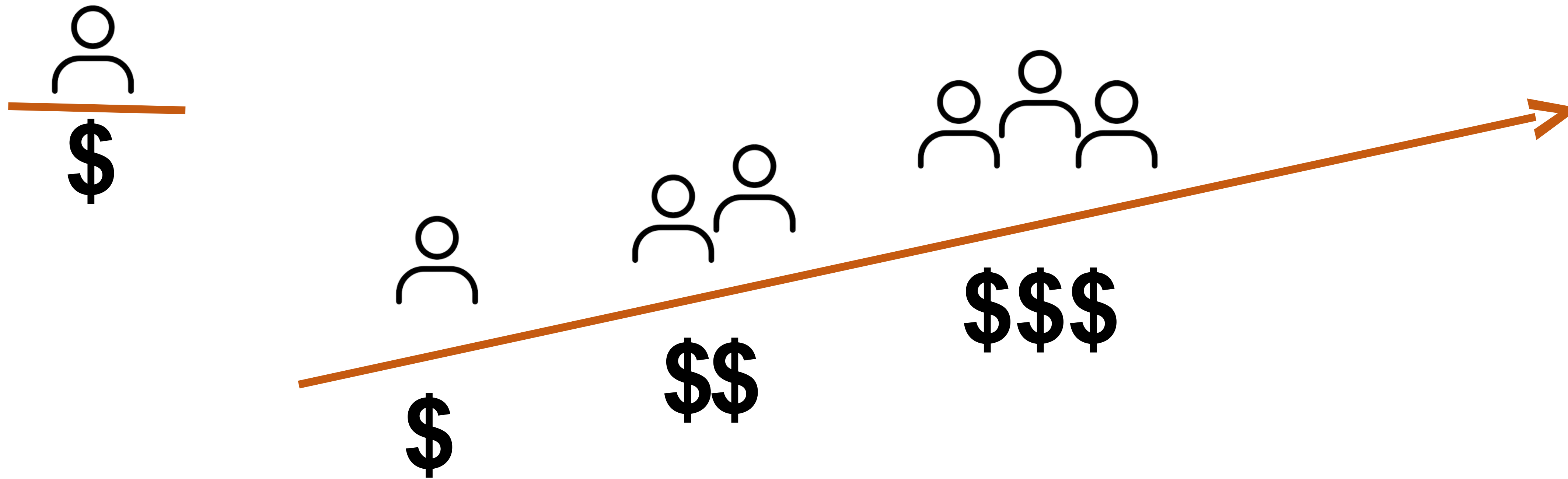
Types of Businesses

Businesses Types - Consulting





Businesses Types - Linear



ALLAMANDA VOYAGES

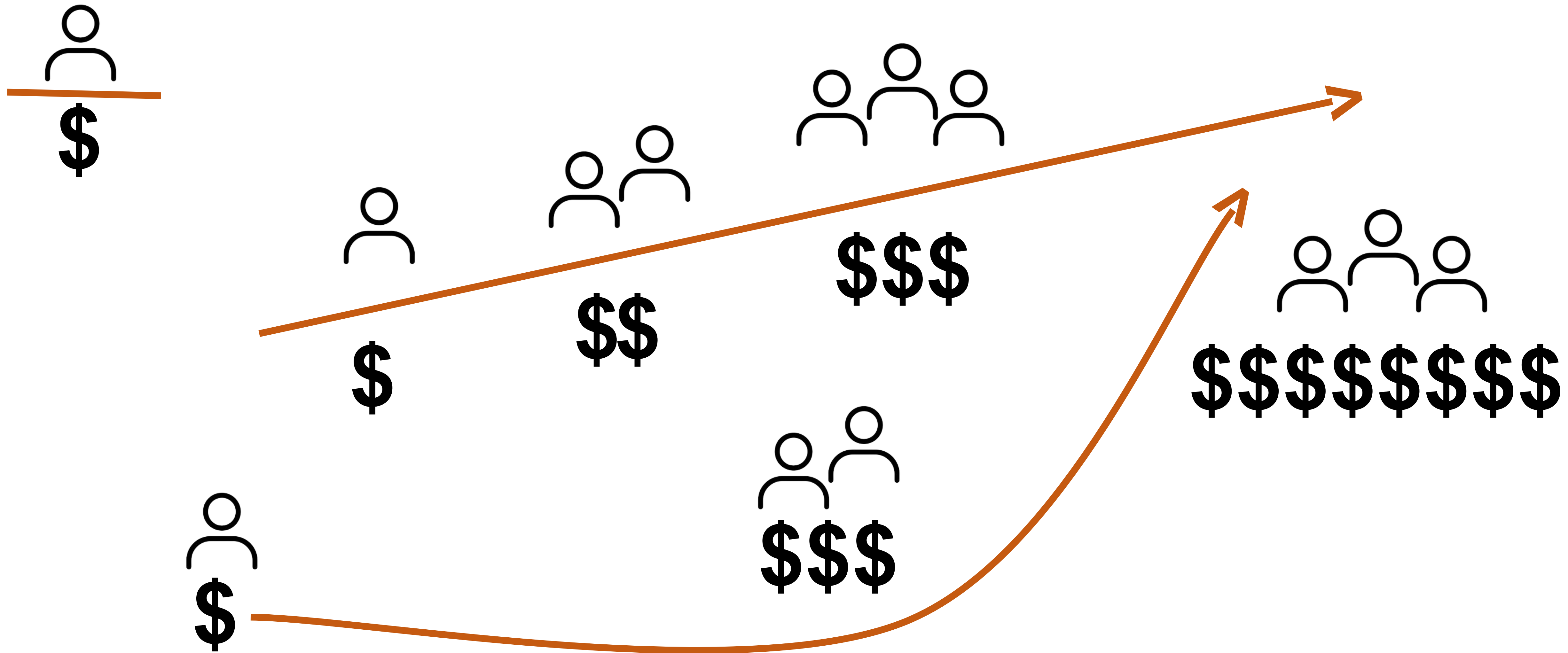


www.allamanda-voyages.fr

**SAFARIS
KENYA & TANZANIE**
agent agréé African Road Safaris



Businesses Types - Scalable



KAYAK®



Revenue scales linearly with time and effort invested.

"I do the work, I get paid."

- **Product/Service:** Think direct service delivery, made-to-order items, or limited inventory.
- **Team:** Usually just you, maybe a few helpers or part-time contractors.
- **Business Model:** Selling stuff or services straight to your customers.
- **Systems:** You can get by with manual processes, adding a little automation as you go.
- **CEO Role:** You're hands-on daily, handling service delivery, sales, support, and ops. It's mostly execution—you won't really move into a leadership role unless you decide to start hiring.

Consulting Business Profile

✓ Pros:

- Simple to start: Immediate income once customers buy.
- Deep personal connection with the work and customers.
- Great for "craftsman," "technician," or "service professional" personality types.
- Flexibility and autonomy in early stages.

⚠ Cons:

- Hard to grow without working more hours or raising prices.
- Founder often trapped in "time-for-money" cycle
- Taking time off can mean losing income.

Technology creates efficiencies which enables more business to be handled (with or without a larger team).

"I deliver value — but use tech and automation to go further, faster."

- **Product/Service:** Still rooted in a service or physical product — but supported heavily by technology tools.
- **Team:** Founder supported by tech partners/tools (CRM, online store, scheduling software, email marketing automation), which creates the expanded capacity/revenue to hire employees.
- **Business Model:** Direct sales, but with some processes automated.
- **Systems:** Digital systems for customer acquisition, order management, communications.
- **CEO Role:** Balance between *execution* and *leading* — implementing systems, marketing, customer support, fulfillment, hiring. Maintains sales responsibilities while others might support execution of work.

✓ Pros:

- Makes solo or small team businesses more efficient and scalable.
- Allows partial income even while away (e.g., online orders, booking systems running automatically).
- Can serve more customers with less direct labor.
- Easier to track performance, market smarter, and optimize customer experience.

⚠ Cons:

- Upfront investment needed in tools/systems.
- Still largely dependent on the founder's presence/oversight for quality and operations.
- Requires willingness to learn and manage technology tools.

"I build a machine that can grow even without me personally doing all the work."

- **Product/Service:** Often productized, standardized services, tech-enabled products, or platforms (ex: subscription boxes, SaaS tools, franchisable service models).
- **Team:** Team early on (employees, contractors, strategic partners).
- **Business Model:** Revenue can scale without matching labor growth; recurring revenue often involved (subscriptions, licensing, franchising, digital products).
- **Systems:** Strong tech backbone, documented processes, hired specialists.
- **CEO Role:** Leads the company's vision, revenue operations, hiring, partnerships, and growth strategy. Delegates execution to teams/systems. Less "doing" — more decision-making, prioritization, problem-solving.

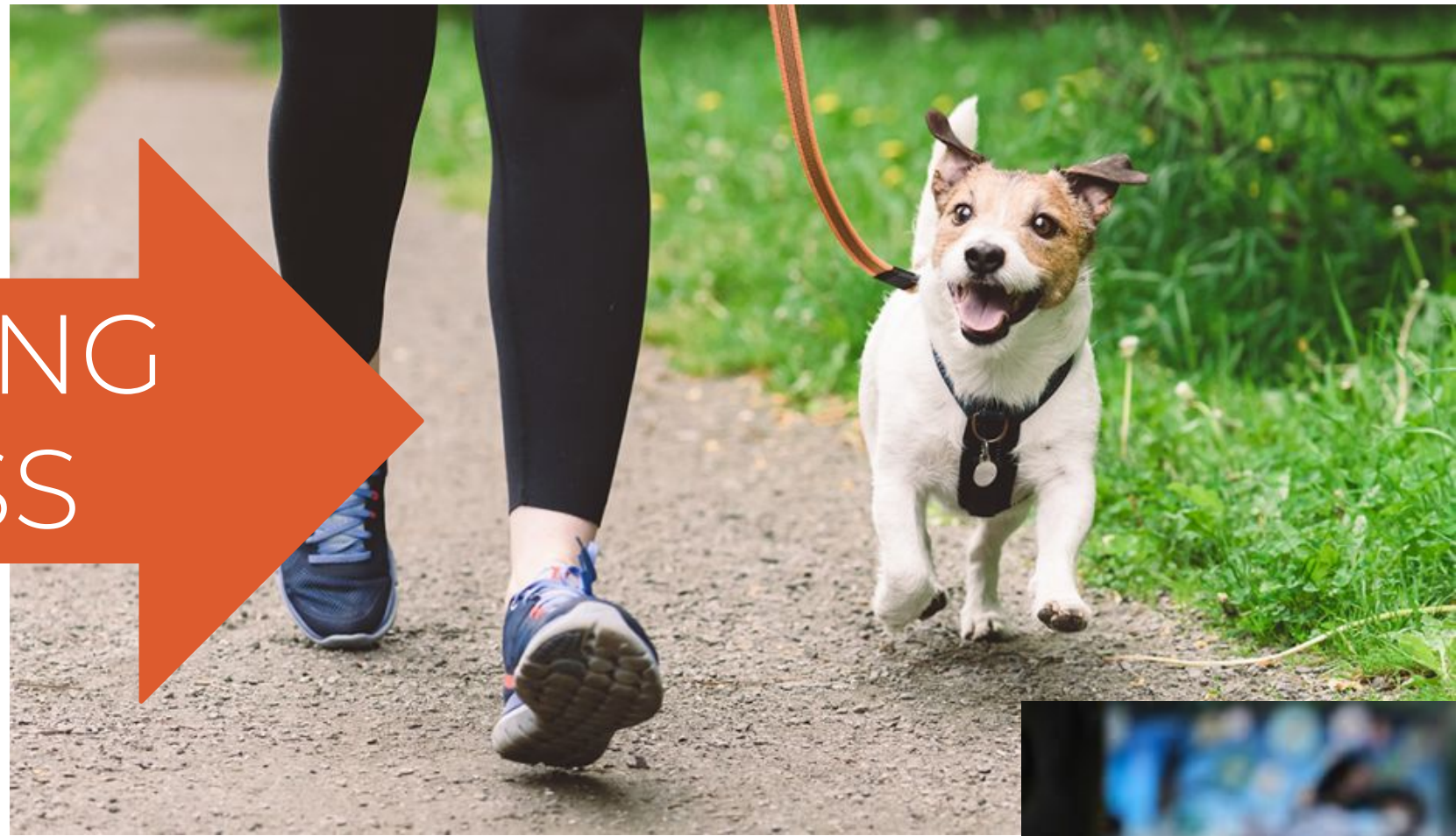
Pros:

- Higher income potential without directly matching time/effort.
- Business value increases over time — potential for exits, licensing, passive income streams.
- Founder can eventually focus more on strategy, partnerships, and leadership.

Cons:

- More complex to start and manage.
- Higher initial investment and risk.
- Leadership skills become critical: must hire, manage, and empower others.
- Takes longer to reach break-even compared to solo models.

CONSULTING
BUSINESS



LINEAR
BUSINESS



SCALABLE
BUSINESS



Examples of Each Business Type

Consulting (limited by your own bandwidth)

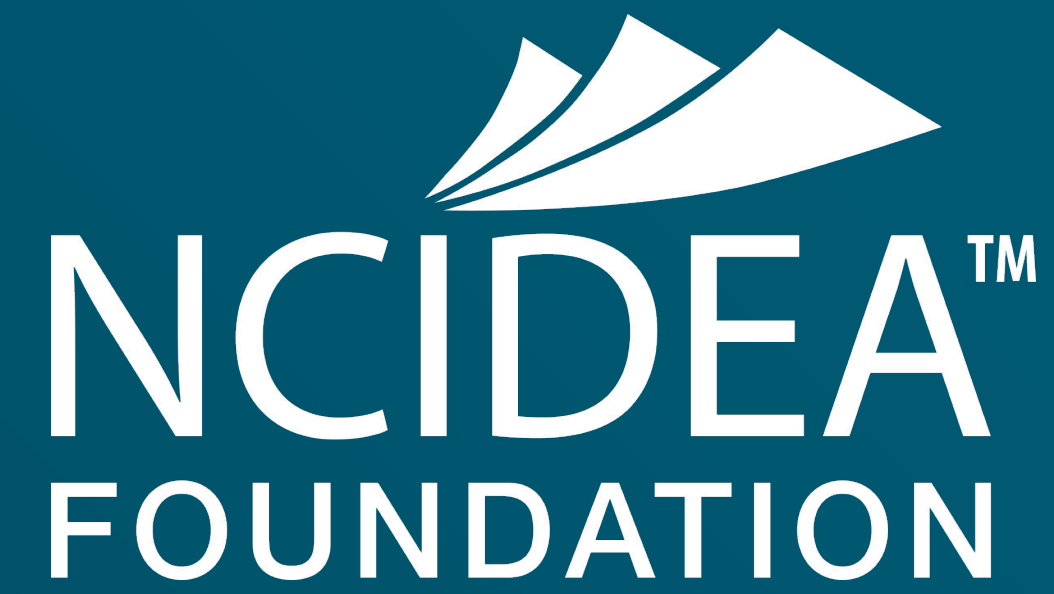
Real Estate Agent, Dog Walker, Handyman, Bookkeeper, Cook, Driver

Linear Business (technology helps you to scale)

Real Estate Agency, Dog Walking Service, Construction Company, Accounting Agency, Restaurant, Greyhound

Scalable Business (technology is the product)

Zillow, Rover, Task Rabbit, Quickbooks, DoorDash, Uber



Fundamental Business Truths

1. **Research**

UNDERSTAND YOUR
CUSTOMER & MARKET,
YOUR OFFERING FITS
THEIR NEED

2. Revenue

OPERATIONS, FINANCE,
EMPLOYEES, SUPPLY CHAIN,
CASH FLOW



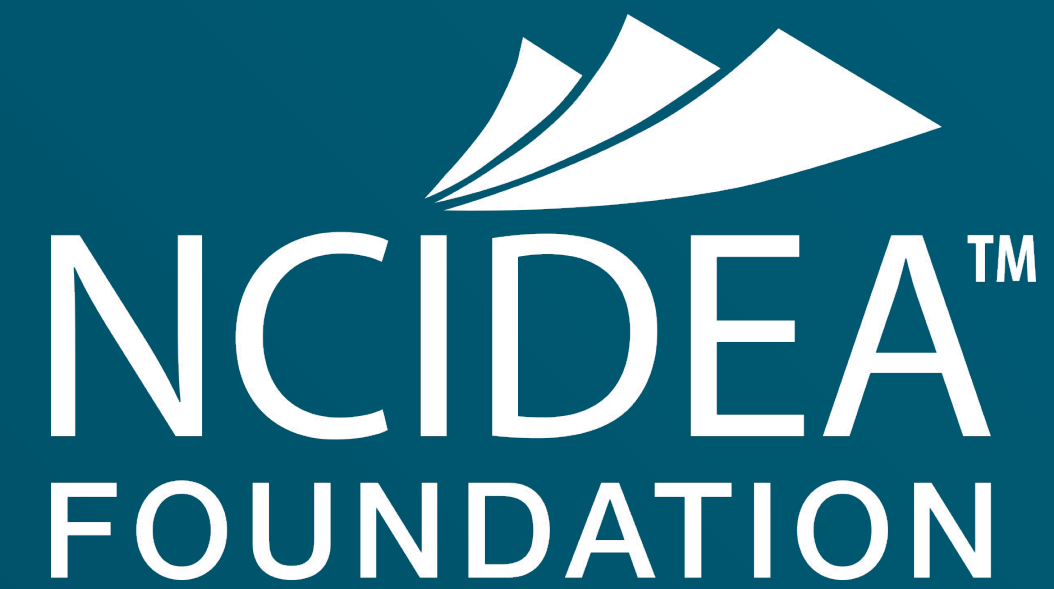
3. Able to connect

rs

REACHING FIRST
CUSTOMERS,
SALES PROCESS,
MARKETING & CHANNELS

4. Follows legal requirements

LEGAL, ACCOUNTING,
LICENSES, REGULATORY,
INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY



BUSINESS OWNER MINDSET

Operating a Business vs. *Leading* a Business

The Worker vs. The Owner – Know the Difference

Worker Mindset

“I do the work myself.”

“My income depends on every hour I personally work.”

“I’m paid for my time or skill.”

“I react to customer needs.”

Owner Mindset

“I design systems and hire/partner so the work gets done.”

“My business can make money even when I’m not working every minute.”

“I create value for customers and capture it through a repeatable product and business model.”

“I intentionally lead the business toward a vision”.

Prepare for Growth from Day 1

Design your business so that it *could* grow

Think in terms of roles your business needs (rather than tasks). What can you delegate, automate, or simplify?

Start with Your Skill, But Build Beyond It

You're building a business, not creating a job for yourself.
Your skill is the seed, not the whole tree.

Build processes around your skill so that people,
technology, or tools can help you deliver your product or
service.

Operate with a Systems Mindset

How does work get done? How do customers find you?
How do you deliver your product/service?

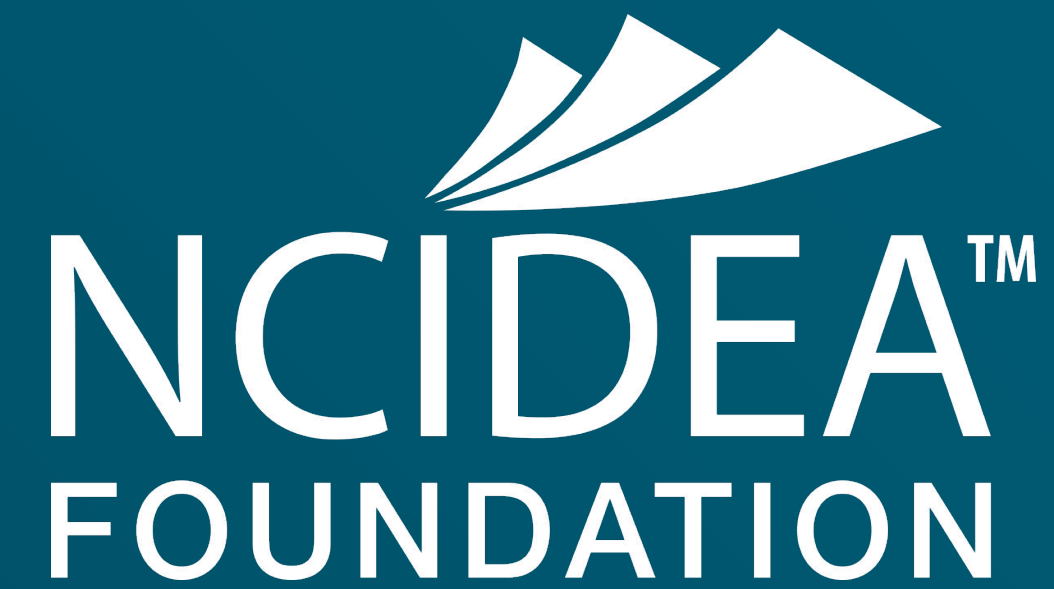
Document, find repeatability, automate with
systems/technology tools.

Focus on Outcomes, Not Just Activities

Avoid the busy work trap.

Prioritize actions that lead to revenue, customers, and systems.

Track key outcomes that become your success metrics.



BUSINESS OWNER BEST PRACTICES

What behaviors get your business off the ground fast?

Manage Your Limited Currencies



Adopt a Bias Toward Action

- *Be proactive*
- *Push for fast decision-making*
- *Be responsive to customers*
- *Do not become complacent*



Revenue Is Queen

- *Drive for fast revenue*
- *Create positive cash flow*
- *Maximize margin*



Go Further Faster With Partners

- *Quickly address gaps and needs with partners*
- *Utilize outsourced or fractional help*



Customer is Always First

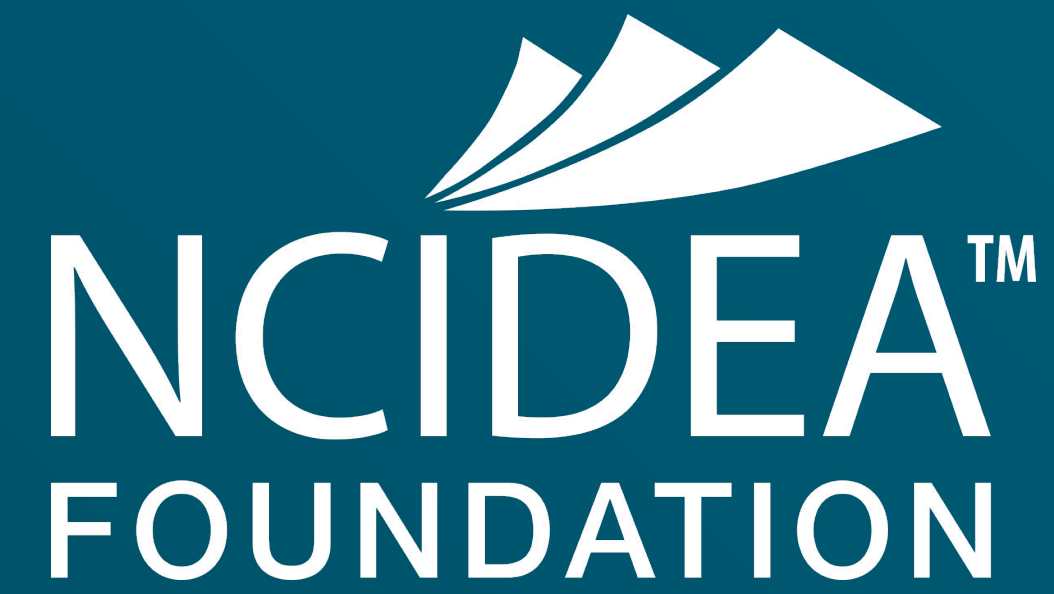
- *Love the problem, not your solution*
- *Understand and adapt to their needs*



- *Conduct all business with respect*
- *Maintain discipline and follow through*
- *Practice gratitude*
- *Ensure consistency*



1. Manage Limited Currencies
2. Bias Toward Action
3. Revenue is Queen
4. Go Further Faster with Partners
5. Customer is Always First
6. Build Trust



One-Page Business Plan

PROBLEM <i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	SOLUTION <i>What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?</i>	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION <i>What makes my offering different from anything on the market?</i>	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY <i>How do I reach my customers?</i>	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES <i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
	OUTCOMES <i>What is the ultimate outcome my customer gets from my offering?</i> <i>How do I measure my business's success?</i>		STARTUP COSTS & REVENUE STREAMS <i>What will it cost to operationalize my business and deliver my solution?</i> <i>How do I make money?</i>	
MY VISION <i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>			MY 90-DAY PLAN <i>Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?</i>	

PROBLEM What problem do my customers need to solve?	SOLUTION What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION What problem have I observed in the market? Why does my business exist– what do my customers need? What are their challenges? What happens if they don't solve this problem? How have they tried to solve this problem?	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY How do I make money?	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES
MY VISION What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?		MY 90-DAY PLAN Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?		

PROBLEM	SOLUTION	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES
<i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	<i>What is my answer to</i>	<i>What makes my</i>	<i>How do I reach my</i>	<i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
Who is your ideal customer? Whose problem are you solving? <i>Get specific.</i> What pain points do they have? What are their characteristics? What does their day-to-day look like? *Are there other important stakeholders? Will you have users who are not customers?				
MY VISION				
<i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>		<i>Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?</i>		

PROBLEM	SOLUTION	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES
<i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	<i>What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?</i>	<i>What makes my offering different from anything on the</i>	<i>How do I reach my customers?</i>	<i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
What is necessary to establish your business and start operating? What does it cost to deliver your offering to any given customer? What is your business model– what does your customer pay for?			STARTUP COSTS & REVENUE STREAMS <i>What will it cost to operationalize my business and deliver my solution?</i> <i>How do I make money?</i>	
MY VISION	MY 90-DAY PLAN			
<i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>	<i>Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?</i>			

PROBLEM STATEMENT <i>What customer problem are you solving?</i> Where do your target customers congregate, online or in the real world? How do they engage with or access similar solutions? What partners might help you to connect with your customers? What marketing strategies work well for your audience?	VALUE PROPOSITION <i>Why would my target customers want to use my solution?</i>	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY <i>How do I reach my customers?</i> STARTUP COSTS & REVENUE STREAMS <i>What will it cost to operationalize my business and deliver my solution?</i> <i>How do I make money?</i>	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES <i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
MY VISION <i>What outcome to I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>	MY 90-DAY PLAN <i>Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?</i>		

PROBLEM <i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	SOLUTION <i>What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?</i>	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION <i>What makes my offering different from anything on the market?</i>	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY <i>How do I reach my customers?</i>	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES <i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
	OUTCOMES <i>What is the ultimate outcome my customer gets from my offering?</i> <i>How do I measure my business's success?</i>		STARTUP COSTS & REVENUE STREAMS	
MY VISION <i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>		Why do your customers engage with your offering over any other alternative? What makes you stand out or sets you apart from your competition? What is the core value your customer gets from working with you? <i>How do I operationalize my vision? What is one action I can take today?</i>		

PROBLEM	SOLUTION	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES
<i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	<i>What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?</i>	<i>What makes my offering different from anything on the market?</i>	<i>How do I reach my customers?</i>	<i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO)</i>
	OUTCOMES <i>What is the ultimate outcome my customer gets from my offering?</i> <i>How do I measure my business's success?</i>	What is the final result that a customer gets from your offering (even psychological or emotional outcomes)? How can you measure that result? What other metrics are important for you to monitor the success of your business?		
MY VISION <i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>		<i>Personalize my vision. What is one</i>		

PROBLEM	SOLUTION	UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES
<i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	<i>What is my answer to their problem - my product or service?</i>	<i>What makes my offering different from anything on the market?</i>	What is my ideal outcome? When I imagine day-to-day work in my business, how do I spend my time? What might my customer/revenue goals be in the next year? What does success look like to me in 5 years?	<i>How do I reach my target customer?</i>
	OUTCOMES			
	<i>What is the ultimate outcome my customer gets from my offering?</i>			
	<i>How do I measure my business's success?</i>			
MY VISION			MY 90-DAY PLAN	
<i>What outcome do I personally want out of this business venture? What does success look like in 1 year? 5 years?</i>			<i>Define my next steps – what do I need to operationalize my business? What unknowns do I need to answer? What is one thing I can experiment with?</i>	

PROBLEM <i>What problem do my customers need to solve?</i>	SOLUTION What aspects of my business do I need more clarity on? What activities can I implement to get the answers I need in a short amount of time? What barriers can I knock down in 3 months that will create more opportunity for my business to grow? What are my immediate priorities? <i>business's success?</i>	UNIQUE VALUE	CHANNELS & OUTREACH STRATEGY <i>How do I reach my customers?</i>	TARGET CUSTOMER PROFILES <i>What are some specific customer types I serve? (WHO PAYS)</i>
			STARTUP COSTS & REVENUE STREAMS <i>What will it cost to operationalize my business and deliver my solution?</i> <i>How do I make money?</i>	
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- 1:1s NEXT WEEK
- WORKSHOP 2 - September 15 @ 5:30PM